



17th August 2026

To Whom It May Concern

I am pleased to provide this expert testimonial in support of **Mr. Kiran Sathyanarayana's** petition for classification as an individual of extraordinary ability in the field of Data Science and Applied Statistics. I have known Mr. Sathyanarayana for more than 17 years, dating back to his MBA studies, during which I taught him Statistics for Management and Marketing Research. Over the years, I have continued to follow his professional and scholarly development with considerable interest, and I have had the opportunity to observe the breadth and maturity of his work across both industry and academia.

I am Professor of AI for Business and Management Science at Queen's Business School, Queen's University Belfast, United Kingdom, where I also serve as Programme Director for the MSc in AI in Business. My research and professional expertise lie in Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, Data Science, Operational Research, and Management Science, with particular emphasis on the application of advanced analytical methods to improve organisational productivity, competitiveness, and societal outcomes. Throughout my academic career, I have published extensively in internationally recognised journals, supervised doctoral researchers, and served on the editorial boards of several leading international journals in areas such as Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, Data Science, and Operational Research. These responsibilities place me in a strong position to evaluate the technical contributions and professional standing of individuals working within these disciplines.

During his MBA programme, Mr. Sathyanarayana consistently demonstrated a strong aptitude for quantitative analysis, statistical reasoning, and evidence-based decision-making. Even at that stage of his career, he possessed an intellectual curiosity and analytical ability that distinguished him from many of his peers. Since then, I have followed his professional development and have reviewed examples of his scholarly and technical work, which demonstrate sustained growth and increasing technical sophistication.

Mr. Sathyanarayana has built an impressive professional career spanning approximately 16 years in Data Science and Artificial Intelligence. His work combines advanced analytical techniques with practical implementation across complex business environments, including consulting engagements with major international organisations. The ability to translate sophisticated analytical methodologies into solutions that deliver measurable organisational value is a distinguishing characteristic of high-calibre practitioners in this field.

In addition to his industrial achievements, Mr. Sathyanarayana has maintained an active commitment to scholarly activity. He has published research papers in Data Science and Artificial Intelligence and has continued to engage with the wider research community. While his primary career has been industry-focused, his continued research activity demonstrates an ongoing commitment to advancing knowledge and contributing to the discipline beyond his immediate professional responsibilities.

Another notable indicator of his professional standing is his service as a reviewer for academic conferences, including the Artificial Intelligence track of the American Marketing Association Conference. The responsibility of evaluating the work of fellow researchers is generally entrusted to individuals who possess recognised subject expertise and sound technical judgement. Such appointments reflect confidence in his ability to assess research quality and scholarly merit.

Mr. Sathyanarayana has also demonstrated a strong commitment to knowledge dissemination and professional development within the wider Data Science community. Through educational content, career mentoring, public articles, and the development of learning resources, he has contributed to improving



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understanding and accessibility of Artificial Intelligence and Data Science for practitioners and aspiring professionals. This willingness to share expertise represents an important contribution to the continued development of the profession.

Having observed his progression over many years, I believe Mr. Sathyanarayana possesses a rare combination of technical expertise, practical leadership, scholarly engagement, and commitment to professional service. His achievements extend beyond technical competence alone; they demonstrate sustained influence across research, industry practice, and professional education.

Based on my knowledge of Mr. Sathyanarayana and my experience of evaluating researchers and professionals working within Artificial Intelligence and Data Science, I consider him to be an individual of exceptional ability whose contributions have had meaningful impact within his field. I have every confidence that he will continue to make significant contributions to research, innovation, and the application of Artificial Intelligence and Data Science in the years ahead.

I therefore offer my strongest professional support for Mr. Sathyanarayana's petition. Should you require any further information, please do not hesitate to contact me at c.vincent@qub.ac.uk.

Sincerely,

Prof. V. Charles

VINCENT Charles

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